

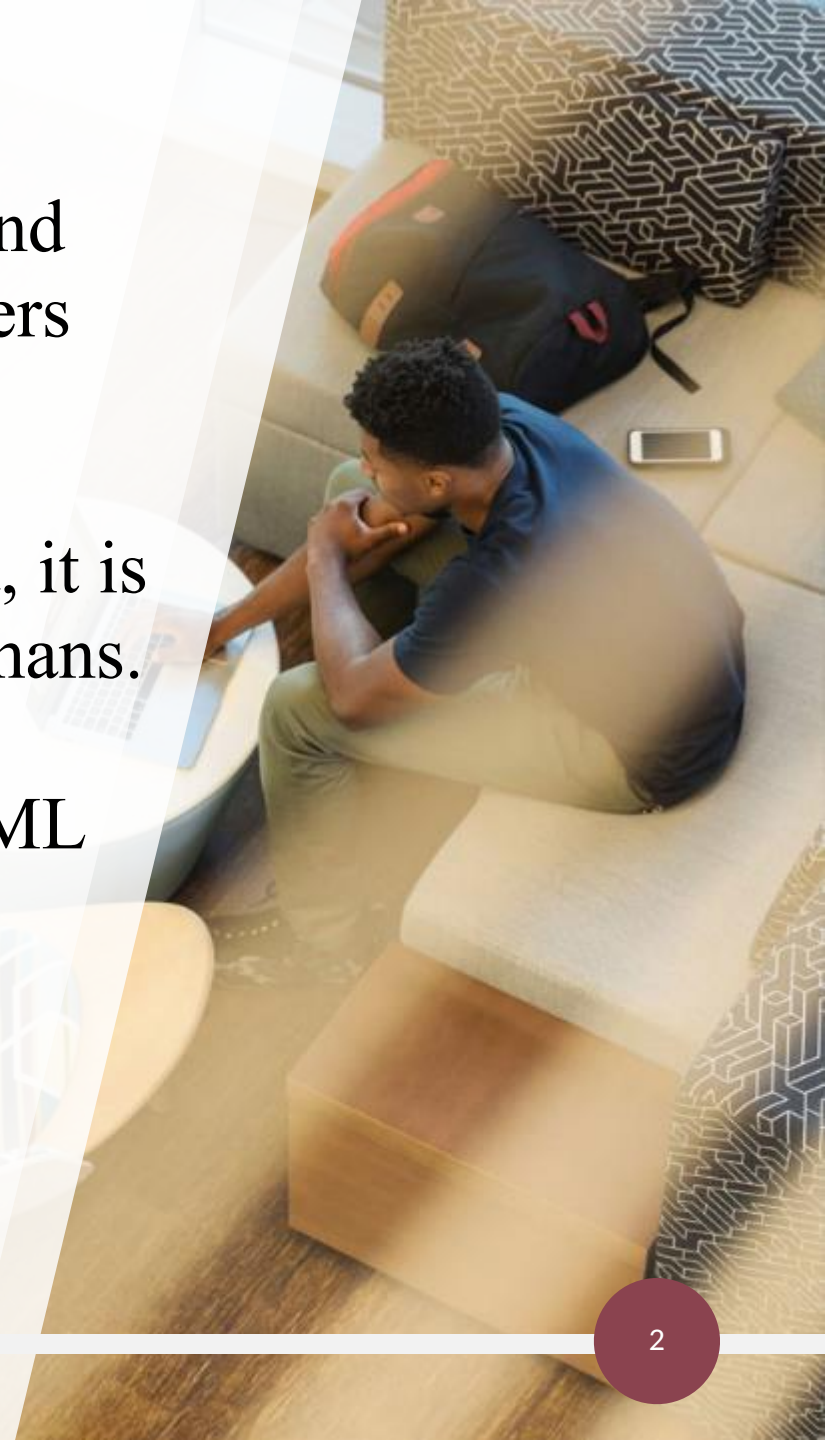
A background image showing four students in a library setting. A young woman on the left is smiling and looking towards the center. A young man in the center is smiling and looking at a laptop. A woman with glasses on the right is looking at the laptop. Another student is partially visible on the far right. The library shelves are filled with books.

Java 25

Markdown Documentation Comments

Motivation

- HTML (Hyper Text Markup Language) is a powerful and standardised markup language consumed by web browsers since the mid 90's.
- However, as HTML is tedious to write and hard to read, it is much less popular as markup manually produced by humans.
- In addition, many new developers are not fluent in HTML (due to its decline as a human-produced format).



Markdown

- [Markdown](#) is a popular markup language that is easy to read/write and easily transformed into HTML (for browsers).
- Invented in 2004 by John Gruber (with help from Aaron Swartz), what distinguishes Markdown from other lightweight markup syntaxes, is its readability.
 - “The overriding design goal for Markdown’s formatting syntax is to make it as readable as possible.” [Gruber]
- Gruber’s canonical description of Markdowns syntax is not unambiguous and has led to differing output from various processors.
- Conveniently, Markdown allows the use of HTML as well (enabling us to use specialised tags for features not available in Markdown).

